the Second World War memorial at Kohima, ‘When you go back tell them of us and say – for your tomorrow we gave our today.’ This should remind the people to honour its brave, undemanding and unsung heroes. We do not have any national war memorial or museum honouring our soldiers, sailors and air warriors who attained martyrdom in the wars fought by a free India, post independence. I strongly advocate that a befitting memorial-cum-museum should come up, as the armed forces have been projecting for a long time, in the area of the India Gate and, if required, a part of the construction could even be below the lawns of the Raj Path, like the underground armed forces museum I visited in Australia. This should not pose any problem as we have the expertise and we have recently made underground metro stations. Like all world powers, we should give the pride of place for such a memorial to our brave soldiers and veterans, at a central location, where the citizens could pay homage in large numbers as is the case in London, Paris or Washington.

To me, spirituality connotes a personal, direct and a very intimate connection with my God – my beliefs and my faith. It is something that I draw my strength from. I most definitely believe that I am guided and protected by a superior force. That force has been kind to me and helped me in following my philosophy of ‘a warrior and a winner’. I am convinced that there is no short cut to success. On assumption of a new appointment, I looked at the big picture, looked forward and never backward, focusing on the horizon with my feet firmly on the ground. In life, I worked very hard at whatever I did and believed that one makes one’s own destiny. It was my endeavour to be innovative and original and do things differently, rather than do the expected. That helped me to be an achiever. Eventually, I think my work always spoke for me. I have very frequently ticked off those officers and men who failed to use their intellect, imagination or initiative while executing an assigned task or mission, and would ask them, in a light-hearted manner, whether they intended to conserve their brains for the next life.